Captions & Transcripts

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

Captions and transcripts textually represent audio content to make media accessible.

Captions are synced with video, making them vital for users who are deaf, hard of hearing, or have cognitive difficulties.

Transcripts provide an untimed text alternative, which helps people who learn best by reading.

How to support it

Many standard platforms make it easy to generate and display these text alternatives.

YouTube and video call tools like Zoom, Microsoft Teams and Google Meet have built-in captions. Many also give you a transcript of a recording.

Tools like YouTube, Microsoft Teams or Slack can auto-generate a transcript when you upload a video. Simply copy the text, fix any odd punctuation, and share the final document.

Useful Links

- W3C WAI: Transcripts
- What are Captions?
- YouTube: Add subtitles and captions
- How to Create a Transcript: A Step-by-Step Guide (2025)